

Michael Tueting

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Education

University of St.Gallen, Switzerland

Ph.D. Economics and Finance, 2020 to 2026 (expected)

Thesis committee: Roland Hodler, Beatrix Eugster, Ferdinand Rauch, Adam Storeygard

Tufts University, United States

Visiting Ph.D. student, August 2023 to June 2024

Hosted by Adam Storeygard

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, United States

Non-degree coursework, 2023 to 2024

International Trade I & II (attended without formal credit)

Leibniz University Hannover, Germany

M.Sc. Economics, graduated with distinction, 2018 to 2020

B.Sc. Economics, 2015 to 2018

Fields

Primary Fields: International Economics, Regional Economics

Secondary Fields: Economic Development, Environmental Economics

Job Market Paper

Climate Change, Income Inequality, and Migration in a Spatial Economy [Link to latest version](#)

Negative local labor market shocks create strong incentives to migrate, yet low-income households often remain in place. This paper studies how income shapes migration responses to climate change and the resulting welfare effects. Using Brazilian Census data, I show that high-income individuals are systematically more mobile than low-income individuals from the same origin. To interpret this pattern and quantify the impacts of climate change, I develop a dynamic spatial general equilibrium model with monetary migration costs and liquidity constraints, embedded in a two-sector trade framework in which rising temperatures depress agricultural productivity. The quantitative results imply sharply regressive welfare losses: in already hot regions, low-income households experience permanent consumption declines of about 0.6-0.9% per period, with worst-case losses near 3.3%, while richer households are largely insulated. Two mechanisms drive these disparities: climate shocks reduce agricultural wages in hot areas, and monetary migration costs disproportionately burden low-income individuals, limiting their ability to relocate in response. A counterfactual policy that makes low-income individuals as mobile as high-income individuals—modeled as a targeted subsidy—raises low-income individuals' welfare by 24%, offsets 4% of climate losses, and increases aggregate output by relocating labor to more productive regions. Adaptation to climate change depends not only on where productivity shocks occur but also on who can afford to relocate. Consequently, adverse shocks tend to fall disproportionately on those unable to afford relocation.

Working Papers

Skill Supply, Firm Size, and Economic Development (with Charles Gottlieb and Markus Poschke). In *World Development Report 2024 Background Papers*, World Bank. [Link to latest version](#)

Papers in Progress

The Economic Geography of Wage Distributions.

Infrastructure, language, and the making of a common market (with Roland Hodler and Paul Schaudt).

References	Prof. Dr. Roland Hodler University of St.Gallen Rosenbergstrasse 22 CH-9000 St. Gallen, Switzerland +41 71 224 2578 roland.hodler@unisg.ch Prof. Adam Storeygard, Ph.D. Tufts University 177 College Ave. Medford, MA 02155, USA +1 (617) 627 6653 adam.storeygard@tufts.edu Prof. Markus Poschke, Ph.D. McGill University 855 Sherbrooke St West Montreal, QC H3A 2T7, Canada +1 (514) 398 1233 mposchke@gmail.com
Teaching	University of St.Gallen, Switzerland Political Economics, teaching fellow for Professor Hodler, 2021 to 2022 Economics of Climate Change, teaching fellow for Professor Eisenbarth, 2023 Public Sector Economics, teaching fellow for Professor Hodler, 2022 to 2025 Development Economics, teaching fellow for Professor Hodler, 2020 to 2025 Nation Building, teaching fellow for Professor Hodler, 2024 to 2025 Data Science, teaching fellow for Professor Matter, 2021 to 2023 Leibniz University Hannover, Germany Macroeconomics I, teaching fellow for Professor Gassebner, 2017 to 2019 Operations Management, teaching fellow for Professor Helber, 2017
Professional activities	University of St.Gallen, Switzerland Research assistant for Roland Hodler, 2020 to 2025 The Bayelsa State Oil & Environmental Commission, Nigeria/UK Research assistance, 2021 Leibniz University Hannover, Germany Research assistant for Richard Bluhm, 2018 to 2020
Grants	Mobi.Doc Fellowship, University of St. Gallen (2023) — CHF 47,333 Awarded a competitive fellowship supporting a year-long research visit to Tufts University, hosted by Adam Storeygard. During this time, I engaged closely with faculty and graduate students, participated in seminars at Tufts, audited graduate trade courses at MIT, and attended research events at Harvard and MIT. The visit significantly advanced my job-market paper and expanded my professional network in trade and development economics. Google Cloud Research Credits Program (2023) — USD 1,015 Provided cloud computing resources to support the empirical analysis in my job market paper.
Conferences and Seminars	2025: Development Economics Network Switzerland (Zürich, Switzerland), Verein für Socialpolitik Annual Conference (Cologne, Germany), Political Economy of Global Development Workshop (Stuttgart, Germany), 2024: Tufts Economics and Public Policy Workshop (Medford, United States), 2023: North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (Toronto, Canada), European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (Milan, Italy), German Development Economics Conference (Dresden, Germany), Annual Congress of the Swiss Society of Economics and Statistics (Neuchâtel, Switzerland), Warwick Economics PhD Conference (Coventry, UK), Young Swiss Economists Meeting (Zürich, Switzerland)
Languages	German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)